



DEAR BOSS: Care for a scoop? Real big one? BELA-FONTE'S COMING TO TOWN! Aug. 11 at the Metropolitan stadium. And he's winging in with a company that includes a 16-piece band, 12-voice choral group and two dance teams. In a chartered plane. In the event of rain, the "King of Calypso" and his troupe will perform in the Minneapolis auditorium Monday, Aug. 12. Why don't you take your bongo-bongos down and give HIM a treat! . . . Spring is here, tra-la: Monday at 9:30 a.m. the swans will make their debut at Loring park—if you'd care to be one of the welcoming committee . . . For one of the finest pieces of screen entertainment your eyes will focus upon catch "Spirit of St. Louis." You don't have to be a hot pilot to experience some genuine thrills crossing the pond with Lindy in that single-engine put-put. Even if you DO know the ending . . . Ray Korpi insists he overheard it in the main postoffice. A woman started to leave a window, only to have the clerk call her back with "Hey lady, you need another airmail stamp on this letter—it's too heavy." But she just laughed and laughed. "Silly!" she said. "If I put another stamp on it, it'll be even heavier!"

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TOMORROW'S EGG AND PARADE day will be celebrated in grand style at the annual brunch in Hotel Radisson's Flame Room. Much chapeau finery will be paraded to the sweet rhythms of Don McGrane's strings. "The Bunny Hop" will introduce the younger fry's showing and there'll be a prize awarded to the best-dressed fellow, too. AND real live, two-footed bunny girls doling out chocolate eggs . . . Today the postoffice expects to deliver 1,000 to 1,200 extra special deliveries. A good portion of them will be baby chicks in pairs and threesomes sent specially to the kids by clucking parents. Other "specials" will be Easter baskets with the telltale handles sticking out! . . . Bunnygrams, sent out by Western Union, on an official decorated blank with eggs of rainbow colors showing Peter and an off-duty helper rabbit will be popular all day tomorrow, too. How'd you like to receive one reading: "Go to bed early and sleep real tight. I'll come hopping around to see you tonight."—Exciting, huh?

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MOVE OVER CALYPSO, 'n' rock 'n' roll—country-western's moving in! That is, according to record dealers. For example: Dinah Shore's "Cattle Call"; Marty Robbins' "White Sport Coat"; Marvin Rainwater's "Find Me a Bluebird." and Jim Reeves' "Four Walls." However, calypso is holding its own. The Norman Luboff Choir has a "Calypso Holiday" album out; authentic Jamaican rhythms come from Lord Flea's "Swinging Calypso" LP. "Roger Williams Plays Music of the Fabulous 50's" is a best seller; "Sing a Song of Paris" with the Ray Charles Singers and Tennessee Ernie Ford's "Spirituals" are getting much spinning. The Hollywood Bowl series has turned out another goodie "Chopin By Starlight" and if it's jazz you crave, Paul Weston's "Crescent City" portrays every mood of sparkling New Orleans. For a few oldies done in the style you like, "Key Men" with Larry Sonn and his group should please. Look for a contemporary of yours to stage a fast comeback—the first of the great crooners—Gene Austin—whose records hit over 86 million—still a record. His current hit—"Too Late." He can croon that "My Blue Heaven" tune to me anytime!

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"PLAY BALL DAY" is a-coming right soon again. This Thursday. Don't you think you should treat yourself to a half day off? The barber won't miss you. And you'll really get your money's worth the next week. Someone dropped off a 1957 baseball brochure compiled by George M. Brophy. And, I note, on browsing through, that since 1908, last year's total of 318,326 not only topped the minor league attendance record for the year, but was our biggest yet. Second largest figures were in 1948 with 274,890. Another observation: Seven of the players are bachelors. Rosy Ryan's teammate of a few (?) years ago will be on deck opening day. He's Andy Cohen, field manager of the Indianapolis club. His first gander at our metropolis since '38 . . . Another baseball note: Orlando Cepeda, who led the club in home runs for spring training, had a father who was the Babe Ruth of Puerto Rico. Will we be witnessing another? . . . And, if you care, Lee Tate was a next door neighbor of Elvis Presley in Memphis, Tenn. . . . Think that on Thursday we'll hit the 18,366 attendance of last year's opener?

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EASTER BRINGS a mild headache to the park board maintenance division. Fond parents who buy their small fry those cute little ducks and geese for Easter tire of them and many wind up in Loring park or Birch pond for the park board to care for. Last year, some 60 of these winged waifs were left on the lakes and ponds with the rest of the park board's navy. This includes a variety of swans, geese, mallards, ducks and a wild whistling swan. Maintenance boss Ben Johnson's 15-man field force are right in the midst of their annual spring housecleaning of the city's park system. They've just completed rolling up some six miles of snow fence and are now raking debris from 3,500 acres of lawn area, sweeping and cleaning 200 tennis courts, cleaning and patching 61 miles of parkways, putting up play equipment at 62 playgrounds, replacing 200 traffic signs, raking and repairing 150 softball fields and 45 baseball fields, repairing 625 public settees and shaping up more than 1,000 acres of picnic grounds. I'm exhausted, aren't you? But have a Happy Easter anyhow.—YOUR GAL, MAGILL.